

NOW STUDY THE USAGE OF TENSES :

1. Simple Present if used in the following situations :

(i) To express present actions or events or facts :



I **get up** at 6 a.m.

The train **leaves** at 7 p.m.

Leave your bed when the bugle sounds.

Lipika **looks** very beautiful.

Rabin **goes** to school.

I **don't like** tea, but I **prefer** coffee.

(ii) To express a habitual action :

I **get up** everyday at 6 a.m.

He **takes** milk every morning.

The elephant **plays** football in the circus.



- (iii) To express a historical fact :

The Sepoy Mutiny of 1857 **is** a turning point in the history of freedom movement in India.

- (iv) To express general truth or eternal truth :

The earth **moves** round the sun. Fortune **favours** the brave.

- (v) In Imperative sentences :

Draw a straight line. **Don't run** in the sun.

Stop writing and **hand over** the answer-scripts.

- (vi) In Exclamatory sentences beginning with **here** and **there** :

Here **comes** the bus! There **goes** the bell!

- (vii) In quotations and reporting :

Keats **says**, "A thing of beauty **is** a joy for ever." (Quotation)

They **tell** me that you **are** a fool. (Reporting)

- (viii) To indicate a future event that is a part of a present plan or arrangement :

They **leave** (**are going to leave**) for London by the next mail. His father **sails** for the Andamans next Sunday. When **does** the school reopen?

- (ix) To use verbs of perception, verbs of appearing and verbs of emotion (**see, hear, look, seem, feel** etc.) :

I **see**, you are a fool. I **hear** the buzzing sound. You can't **feel** her sentiment.

- (x) In clauses of time and condition :

I shall wait till you **finish** your lunch. If it **rains** we shall get wet.

2. Present Progressive/Continuous is used in the following situations :

- (i) For an action going on at the time of speaking :

What **is** Lila **doing** now? (Interrogative)

Lila **is dancing** now. (Assertive)

Who **are playing** football? (Interrogative)

The boys **are playing** football. (Assertive)

The police **are talking** to a nurbet of people. (Assertive)

- (ii) Imagining an unseen activity :

I think Subhendu **is lying** in bed at home. His friends **are doing** Mathematics now.

- (iii) For an action that is planned or arranged to take place in the near future :

Dipu and his friends **are leaving** Kolkata tonight.

Bela and her friends **are arriving** here tomorrow.

- (iv) For giving information about a third person's whereabouts :

Where is Debika? She's (= **she is**) **watering** the plants in her garden.

- (v) For explaining what one is doing :

What **are you doing**? I'm (= I am) **drawing** a picture.

- (vi) For describing :

Which girl is Nipa? What **is she wearing** today?

She is slim and beautiful. She **is wearing** a white sari today.



3. Present Perfect is used in the following situations :

- (i) To indicate a completed action in the immediate past :
He **has** just **gone** out. The clock **has struck** ten.
I **have cut** my finger and it is bleeding now.
- (ii) To express past actions whose time is not definite :
Mr. Roy **has been** to Japan. I **have never known** him to be angry. **Have** you **ever been** to Delhi? **Have** you **read** 'Gulliver's Travels'? I **have complained** about this problem before. Sachin Tendulkar has broken the record of centuries in One-Day match.



- (iii) To denote an action beginning at sometime past and continuing up to the present moment :

I **have known** him for a long time. We **have lived** here for ten years. We **haven't seen** Padmini for several months. He **hasn't finished** his work yet.

Note We see that these adverbs or adverbials can be used with the present perfect :
just, often, so far, till now, already, since, for, never; ever (in questions only);
yet (in negatives and questions).

- (iv) To denote relation between what happened in the past and the present time :
I **have found** the letter you were looking for.

- (v) To denote duration of event :

We **have lived** here for 5 years. Prices **have fallen** sharply over the past 6 months.

- (vi) To denote that an action has been repeated a number of times :

He **has visited** Bhutan several times.

4. Present Perfect Continuous is used :

- (i) For an action which began sometime in the past and is still continuing :
She **has been sleeping** for six hours. He **has been playing** since 4 p.m.
They **have been building** the bridge for several years.

Note This tense is sometimes used for an action already finished. In such cases the continuity of the activity is emphasized as an explanation of something.
"Why are your clothes wet?"—"I **have been watering** the plants."

- (ii) When we ask questions with 'How long' and get answers thereof :
How long have you been waiting for me?

I **have been waiting** for you for an hour.

- (iii) To focus the recent activity with its present results :

Your eyes are red—have you been crying? (= recently stopped)

5. Simple Past is used in the following situations :

- (i) To talk about a past event as a simple fact of time. It often occurs with adverbs or adverb phrases :

Haradhan **left** school last year. The steamer **sailed** a week ago.

I **received** his letter yesterday.

- (ii) Sometimes without an adverb of time. In such cases, the time may be either implied or indicated by the context :

I **didn't sleep** well. (i.e., last night)

'Where **did** he **learn** Hindi?'

'He **learned** Hindi in Patna.' (i.e., in sometime past)

- (iii) Simple Past is also used with 'used to/would' for past habits.
 He **used to study** many hours everyday.
 My grandmother **would bathe** in the Ganga in her old age.
 She always **carried** (= **would carry**) an umbrella.

Note 'Used to' is very often used in writing and 'would' in speech.

- (iv) For situations that existed for a period of time in the past but not now :
 The Mughals **ruled** here for several hundred years.
 When I **was** younger, I played cricket for my school team.
- (v) To talk about how long something went on :
 How long did you live here?
 I stayed here with my grandparents for 3 months.
- (vi) To ask questions about a past action :
 When **did** you **arrive** here? **Did** she **reach** the hostel in time?

6. Past Continuous is used in the following situations :

- (i) To talk about any continuing process of doing something in the past :
 The train was late and they **were waiting** at the station for three hours.
- (ii) To describe a background action :
 X. What **were** you **doing** in the evening yesterday?
 Y. I **was listening** to the radio all evening.
 X. You took a long time to answer the phone.
 Were you **sleeping**?
 Y. Yes, I **was** (sleeping).
- (iii) To denote a temporary situation at or around a particular time in the past :
 At the time of robbery, she **was staying** with her uncle.
 She **was shaking** with fear when they turned away.
- (iv) When we talk about two past actions going on at the same in past :
 I **was watching** the TV while my sister **was reading** a novel.



7. Past Perfect is used in the following situations :

- (i) To describe an action completed before a certain moment in the past :
 I met him in New Delhi in 2005. I **had seen** him last four years ago.
- (ii) If two actions happened in the past, it may be necessary to show which action happened earlier than the other. The past perfect is mainly used in such situations :
 I **had written** the letter before she arrived. I **had wanted** to visit the office before I left for foreign tour.
- (iii) To denote a time expression with by the time, when, etc. :
 I **had gone** to bed when the phone rang.
 The film **had already begun** by the time we got into the cinema.

8. Past Perfect Continuous is used in the following ways :

- (i) To express an action that continued in the past for a given period of time :
 At that time he **had been reading** a novel for two weeks. We **had been expecting** the news for some time.

- (ii) To express a Past Perfect Continuous and a Simple Past with when :
He **had been suffering** from flu when he was interviewed.
- (iii) To ask questions with 'How long' and get answers thereof :
How long **had** you **been** travelling here?
I **had been travelling** here for two months.

9. Ways of talking about the Future :

There are four different ways to talk about the near future :

- (i) by using **going to**, (ii) by using Present Continuous, (iii) by using Simple Present, (iv) by using **will**, **'ll**, **won't**, **shall**.

Look at this table. They give the same facts :

Mr. Roy	(i) is going to leave (ii) is leaving (iii) leaves (iv) will leave	tomorrow morning.
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Note Such type of future is coloured with intention or arrangement.
But to express pure or colourless future we use only Simple Future Tense (**shall/will** + **verb**).

10. Simple Future is used in the following situations :

- (i) To talk about simply to some future event :
I **shall do** this work. We **shall enjoy** life together. I'll **have** my dinner at 9 p.m. tonight. They **will meet** us in the hotel. There **won't be** any ceremonial party this year as we've lost a member of the club. They **will not admit** children under five. **Will he come back** this evening?
- (ii) If two future actions are joined by **when**, the one will be in the Future Tense (any form) and the other will be in Simple Present Tense :
I **shall leave** the place **when she comes**. She **will do** it when you **come**.

Note Sometimes Simple Future Tense is used with a Simple Present Tense : Don't worry, I'll get it.

11. Future Continuous is used in the following situations :

- (i) When we talk about an activity going on at a particular time in future :
Next Thursday, we **will be celebrating** our Dipu's birthday.
- (ii) To talk about near future :
We **will be leaving** for Mumbai tonight.
- (iii) To refer to some future activities previously arranged :
She **will be helping** us to organise the party. We **will be joining** you at night.
- (iv) To ask someone politely about the immediate future :
Will/Would you **be using** the computer for long?

12. Future Perfect Tense is used in the following situations :

- (i) To denote something that will be ended in future :
We shall have finished our task before the sun sets. They will have reached school before the rain starts.

- (ii) To denote the completion of some events in the past before starting an event in future :

We hope the situation **will have improved** before we reach there.

- (iii) To describe the future events in less certain way :

By the time you get home, I **will/should have cleaned** the house.

13. Future Perfect Continuous Tense is used in the following situations :

- (i) To denote an activity by a certain future time :

He **will have been studying** in London when he gets his degree.

- (ii) To emphasize how long something could be going on over a period of time in future :

Next year, he **will have been researching** at JNU for three years.

INFINITIVE AFTER 'ABOUT'

'About' denotes 'about to do'.

He was **about to go** to school. The rose was **about to bloom** but did not bloom.

PERFECT INFINITIVE

When the action expressed by the Infinitive is regarded as completed, the Perfect Aspect of the Infinitive is used.

He seems **to have acted** properly. They seem **to have forgotten** to come here.

SOME IMPORTANT USAGES

He **came** here yesterday, (not 'has come')

The president **made** (delivered) a nice speech.
(not 'gave')

His brother will not **appear** at (sit for) the examination.
(not 'will not give')

He **refused** to come. (not 'denied')

He **denied** his guilt. (not 'refused')

We **declined** his invitation. (not 'denied')

He has come **to see** me. (not 'for seeing me')

He will **stay** in Kolkata for five days. (not 'live')

We **live** in Kolkata. (not 'stay')

Will you **listen to** his advice? (not 'hear')

They **are mistaken**. (not 'have mistaken')

The man was **drowned** in the river. (not 'sank')

The boat **sank** in the river. (not 'drowned')



EXERCISE

1. Fill in the blanks with the correct form of tense of the Verbs given in brackets :

- The earth.....(move) round the sun and the sun.....(give) us light.
- He always.....(buy) lottery tickets but never.....(win) any prize.
- Are you.....(go) to school now?